Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative

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PAPER PERFECTION

THE HANDMADE ART OF SANGANER



Sanganeri handmade paper is a traditional craft originating from Sanganer, a town near Jaipur. The history of the paper dates back to the 16th and 17th centuries, when artisans, influenced by Mughal aesthetics, began producing high-quality paper for royal courts, manuscripts, and religious texts.







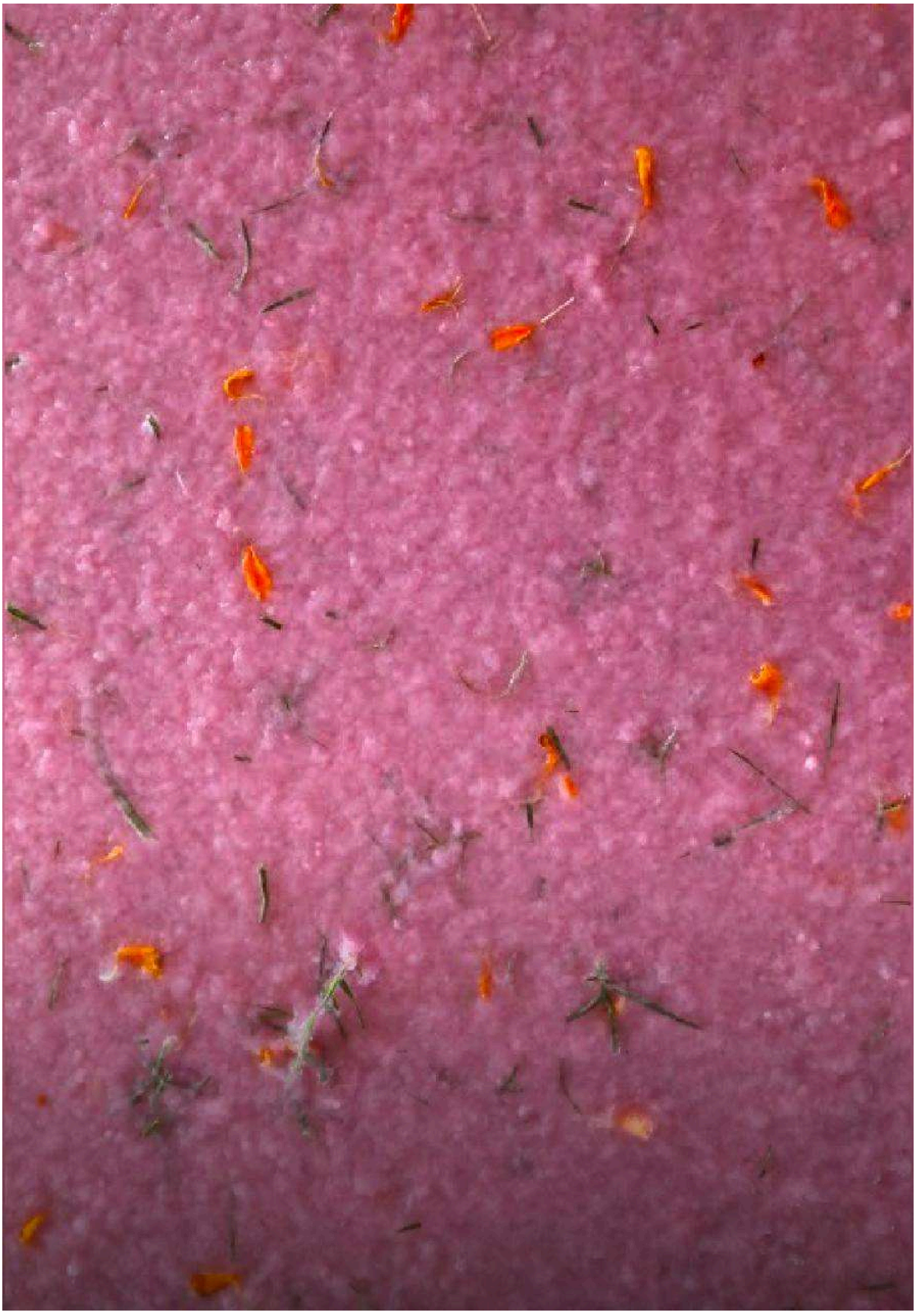
This paper is made using eco-friendly methods. The process begins with collecting and cleaning cotton rags, which are soaked in water and beaten into a fine pulp. Spangles, glitter, flecks of grass and petals are mixed into the pulp to embellish the texture. The pulp is then spread onto mesh screens and hand-pressed to remove excess water before being sun-dried. This results in sheets of strong, textured handmade paper, free from chemicals and bleaches.







Once dried, the paper is decorated using the traditional block-printing technique used in Sanganeri textiles where wood blocks with intricate floral and geometric designs are dipped in natural dyes and carefully stamped onto the paper and often embellished with gold stencil work. The paper is used for stationery, gift wrapping, journals, and decorative packaging.









Sanganeri handmade paper differs from other handmade papers such as the Kagzi paper (Jaipur, India) made from recycled cotton rags, which is lightweight, and is used for calligraphy and painting. Washi paper (Japan) made from mulberry bark fibers is thin, strong, plain or subtly decorated. Lokta paper (Nepal) made from daphne plant bark is highly fibrous, textured, and durable, and is used for documents and bookbinding.



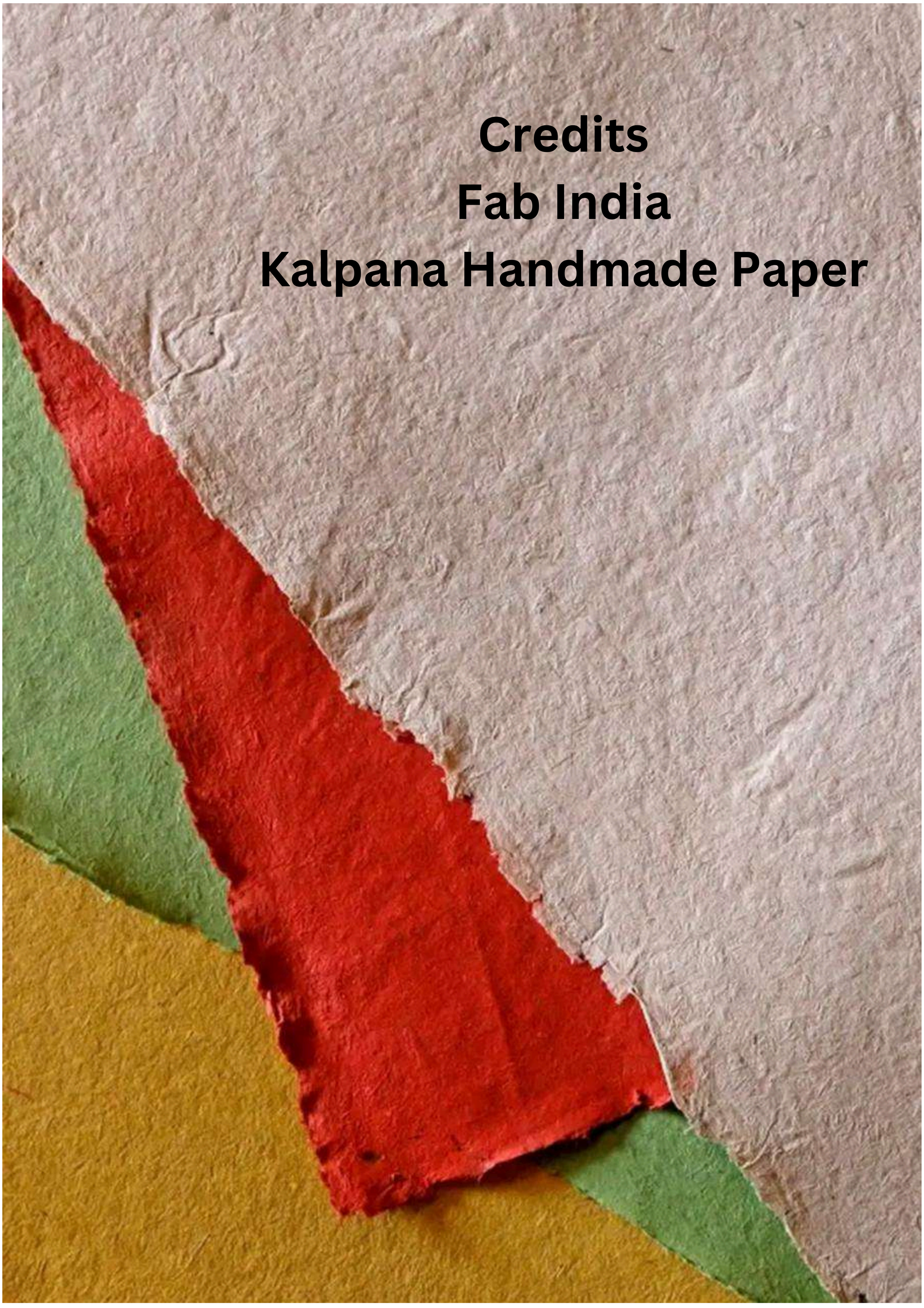




Despite its rich heritage, Sanganeri handmade paper has faced challenges, including competition from industrial paper mills and lack of recognition for its artisans.



Efforts to revive and promote Sanganeri handmade paper continue through government initiatives, artisan cooperatives, and eco-conscious brands. With growing awareness of sustainable products, this craft remains a symbol of heritage, craftsmanship, and environmental responsibility, ensuring that the artisans' skills and traditions live on for future generations.


Credits
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Kalpana Handmade Paper